

you to change features like - Contrast, Brightness, Luminance, Colour tone, Effects, Clone, Paint, Draw and others, and a Layers Panel where you can overlay images to create a new image. For most multimedia editing, having a sound understanding of photographic editing is sufficient.

Photographic editing is inherent to video as well since any footage is nothing but a fast moving series of images. The edits that look good in still photographs, such

as sepia tone, may look out of place in a video file. For this purpose the most important part of image editing for multimedia is understanding Colour tone, Grading and Grain. Every digital change to a photograph causes the underlying pixels to be artificially



Even the most basic online image editing apps today can do amazing edits on automatic settings.

changed beyond their original parameters. The best software can compensate for the loss in quality using sophisticated backend programming but eventually give rise to a grainy quality which is indicative of poor lighting conditions in most cases.

In multimedia projects this “Grain” quality is not always desirable and needs to be balanced such that the image looks real and natural. The Grain control option allows you to smoothen out the image at the cost of the images detail, for example, a photograph in which the subject is too dark can be improved by increasing “Brightness” but will create grain. Grain Control options like Luminance will smoothen out the grain while keeping the image bright but will lose all the detail in the subject. Colour grading and tone is when you alter the overall colour range - warm or cool - of the photograph.

The same options are available as Effects when working with video images so the technique applies both ways. This process is best learned by experimentation due to the handy WYSIWYG feature of these software. The most important thing to remember is that each photograph has its own unique set of features and unique set of required corrections. The goal should always be a natural integration of image styles so that the visual experience is seamless and no one image seems out of place or odd in the overall collection. 